Junior/Senior Divisions
Fair Week Expectations

The entire event is held at the Palmer Events Center in Austin, TX: 900 Barton Springs Road, 78704
Parking is free to volunteers, judges, teachers, students, and parents during the fair.

Schedule: Junior and Senior Division Schedule

Wednesday Check-in and Board Setup

All project boards should be checked in to the Palmer Events Center the day before the Fair. A teacher or school representative may bring all project boards and abstracts (the official abstract form from STEM Wizard Files and Forms) to the Center, or parents/students may bring the boards individually. Make sure all project boards have the full project number (Ex. CHEM-4325-JR-T) written in sharpie on the **back right corner** of the board. This is the location where the project will be in the exhibit hall. Students need to know their project numbers to find their boards. The project numbers will be available in STEM Wizard a week before the fair.
Check-in is a 3-step process:

- Check project board(s) in at the registration tables. Volunteers will check that project numbers are on the back of the board.
- Pass through Display and Safety to get the board(s), abstract(s), and any other required paperwork checked for rule violations (Display and Safety Rules). No objects other than boards, binders, laptops/tablets and project paperwork requirements are allowed in the exhibit hall. Boards can not be taller than 60" and can only have paper or photos on them.
- Set up the project board(s) at the assigned booth number(s). To find the booth location, first find the category location (first four letters of the project number). Then look for the number.
- Do not leave any electronics unattended. GARSEF is not responsible for stolen or lost items.

What Students can expect during judging

- Students and teachers should review the Judge Criteria Sheet and practice presentations before the fair.
- **Students should arrive 15 minutes prior to their judging period or earlier if they need to go through Display and Safety again.**
- **No food or drink is allowed in the Exhibit Hall.** Bathrooms and water stations are available inside the Exhibit Hall.
- If a student has an important question or a sudden need, find one of the dozens of volunteers positioned throughout the Exhibit Hall and ask for assistance.
- **Students should remain by their projects until they are dismissed**. This will be done by category. Students are encouraged to bring a book. If students need to use the restroom, they

should ask a volunteer for a note to leave by their project in case judges come by while the students are away from their project.

- **Students should be prepared to provide a brief summary of their project and answer questions from the judges**. Each project will have at least three judges. There may be more than that, including special award judges.
- In the **Senior Division**, some students may advance to Top-Tier Judging, held in the afternoon. Selected students and their projects will be moved to a new area for this judging session before remaining students are released from the morning session. Students will have a short break to notify their teacher or parent and get something to eat prior to the next judging session.

What Teachers and Parents can expect during judging

- Parents and teachers can escort their students to the correct booth in the exhibit hall 15-20 minutes before judging begins. If you forgot the booth number, visit the Registration Table or Information Booth for assistance. The booth number can also be found in STEM Wizard. It is the project number. **Do not bring food or drink into the Exhibit Hall.**
- Make a plan for where to meet your student(s) after they finish with judging. You will not be allowed back in the Exhibit Hall while judging is in process.
- About ten minutes before Judging, parents and teachers will be asked to leave the Exhibit Hall. There are chairs in the Awards Hall (behind the airwall) as well as tables and chairs in the hallway along the side of the Exhibit Hall. Judging cannot begin until all parents and teachers leave the Exhibit Hall, with the exception of the Middle School Teachers who volunteer to be hall monitors.
- Once judging is finished, students are released by category and will go find their teacher or parent.

Awards and Award Ceremony

- During the Award Ceremony, Special Award and Category Award winners will be announced. Trophies, medals, and certificates will be handed out to students on stage. Special award items will be handed out off stage.
- School representatives should pick up student comment sheets after the award ceremony at the table to the right side of the stage. If the teacher will not be there, please identify another person to pick up the comment sheets to take to the school.
- Students, teachers, and families are encouraged to attend the Award Ceremony. If you cannot stay for the ceremony, please make sure another student or teacher picks up any awards for you. You can pick up your project board during the Public Viewing time or have a friend pick up the board as they leave the ceremony. Boards not picked up by 4:00 p.m. on Saturday will be discarded by Palmer Staff.
- Awards will also be listed on our website once the Ceremony is complete. If there is a missing award, please ask the teacher or sponsor to contact GARSEF staff.
- Judges' decisions are final.
- Photos will be uploaded to the web page about a week after the Event